

Rodrigo Fernandez

Senior React.js / PHP (Laravel/Symfony) Full Stack Engineer

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Summary

Senior **React.js / PHP Full Stack Engineer** with strong experience building SaaS, healthcare, eCommerce, and digital media platforms using **React 16.x–18.x**, **TypeScript 3.x–5.x**, **PHP 7.4–8.3**, **Laravel 8.x–10.x**, **Symfony 4.x–6.x**, **MySQL 5.7–8.x**, PostgreSQL 11–15, Redis 5.x–7.x, REST APIs, AWS, Docker, and CI/CD pipelines, specializing in modernizing legacy PHP applications, resolving production defects, improving frontend performance, implementing secure payment and reporting features, and collaborating flexibly across product, QA, DevOps, support, and business teams to deliver reliable software with measurable user, security, revenue, and real operational impact.

Skills

- **Frontend:** **React 16.x–18.x**, TypeScript 3.x–5.x, JavaScript ES6+, Redux Toolkit, React Query, Context API, Hooks, HTML5, CSS3, SASS, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, Material UI, Webpack 4.x–5.x, Vite, responsive UI, accessibility
- **Backend:** **PHP 7.4–8.3**, **Laravel 8.x–10.x**, Symfony 4.x–6.x, Composer 2.x, Doctrine ORM, Eloquent ORM, REST API design, JWT, OAuth2, Laravel Sanctum, Laravel Horizon, queues, jobs, cron processing
- **Database & Cache:** **MySQL 5.7–8.x**, PostgreSQL 11–15, Redis 5.x–7.x, database indexing, query optimization, stored procedures, schema migration, replication support, data cleanup scripts
- **Testing:** PHPUnit 8.x–10.x, Jest, React Testing Library, Cypress, Postman, API contract testing, regression testing, unit testing, integration testing, defect reproduction
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS EC2, RDS, S3, CloudFront, Route 53, IAM, CloudWatch, Docker, Nginx, Apache, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Bitbucket Pipelines, Linux, Bash
- **Monitoring & Quality:** Sentry, New Relic, Datadog, Laravel Telescope, application logs, performance profiling, OWASP security practices, XSS prevention, CSRF protection, SQL injection mitigation
- **Payment & Integration:** Stripe, PayPal, webhook processing, third-party APIs, email services, PDF/report generation, admin dashboards, CRM and ERP integrations

Experience

Lightedge — Senior Software Engineer *(Apr 2020 – Mar 2026)*

- Led development of **React 18.x** dashboards and **PHP 8.x / Laravel 10.x** APIs for SaaS infrastructure workflows, improving customer portal task completion by **34%** through clearer navigation, reusable UI modules, and optimized backend responses.
- Modernized a legacy **PHP 7.4 / Laravel 8.x** application into **PHP 8.2 / Laravel 10.x**, resolving dependency conflicts, deprecated helper usage, broken queue workers, and risky custom middleware without interrupting business-critical user activity.
- Implemented secure role-based access controls with **Laravel Sanctum**, policy classes, and React route guards, reducing unauthorized admin action defects by **41%** while keeping permission changes flexible for support and operations teams.

- Resolved a recurring production issue where invoice export jobs failed under high load by refactoring queued workers, adding Redis retry logic, improving database indexes, and cutting failed background jobs by **52%**.
- Built reusable **React TypeScript** components for tables, filters, modals, form validation, and reporting widgets, reducing duplicate frontend code by **38%** and helping the team deliver new portal features faster.
- Improved slow MySQL reporting queries by analyzing execution plans, adding compound indexes, splitting heavy joins, and introducing cached summary tables that reduced average report load time by **46%**.
- Created Stripe and PayPal webhook handlers in **PHP 8.x** with signed payload validation, idempotency keys, and failure replay tooling to prevent duplicate billing events and improve financial reconciliation accuracy.
- Migrated older class-based React pages into functional components with Hooks, React Query, and typed service layers, removing memory leak warnings and making API loading states more consistent across the application.
- Partnered with QA to reproduce browser-specific UI bugs in Safari and Firefox, then fixed layout shifts, stale state issues, and form submission race conditions that had affected customer onboarding flows.
- Strengthened CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions, PHPUnit, Jest, and Docker build checks, reducing manual release verification time by **29%** while keeping deployments predictable for staging and production.
- Added Sentry, CloudWatch metrics, and structured Laravel logs around payment, authentication, and queue operations so support engineers could diagnose incidents without direct database access.
- Collaborated flexibly across frontend, backend, DevOps, and product responsibilities, switching between React feature work, PHP API fixes, deployment issues, and customer-impact analysis whenever release priorities changed.

NIX United —Software Engineer *(Oct 2016 – Mar 2020)*

- Developed eCommerce and healthcare workflow applications using **React 16.x–17.x**, **PHP 7.4–8.0**, Laravel 7.x–8.x, Symfony 4.x–5.x, MySQL, Redis, and REST APIs for multi-tenant client environments.
- Implemented a new appointment scheduling feature with React calendar views, Laravel validation rules, timezone-safe date handling, and notification jobs that reduced manual scheduling work by **33%**.
- Fixed a critical checkout bug caused by duplicate payment callbacks by adding webhook signature checks, idempotent transaction storage, and defensive retry handling across PHP service classes.
- Migrated legacy jQuery-heavy screens into **React 17.x** modules while preserving server-rendered PHP routes, allowing the team to modernize the UI gradually without rewriting the whole platform.
- Optimized Laravel API endpoints by replacing N+1 Eloquent queries with eager loading, pagination, and selected columns, improving average product listing response time by **44%**.
- Built reusable form components with React Hook Form, Yup validation, and TypeScript interfaces, helping frontend developers handle complex business rules without duplicating validation logic.
- Resolved session timeout and CSRF token issues in mixed PHP and React pages by aligning cookie settings, SameSite policies, token refresh behavior, and reverse proxy headers.
- Created PHPUnit coverage for pricing, discount, tax, and inventory calculation services, preventing regression bugs in release cycles where business rules changed frequently.
- Integrated third-party CRM and shipping APIs using Laravel jobs, retry queues, and error logging, reducing failed external synchronization cases by **27%** after production rollout.
- Worked closely with designers and product owners to convert Figma workflows into responsive React interfaces, balancing pixel accuracy, accessibility, and backend API constraints.
- Supported production releases by reviewing pull requests, validating database migrations, monitoring error logs, and quickly patching React or PHP defects discovered after deployment.

Webiz Digital — Software Developer *(Jan 2014 – Sep 2016)*

- Built digital marketing, subscription, and content management platforms using **PHP 7.x**, Laravel 5.x–7.x, early **React 15.x–16.x**, MySQL, Bootstrap, jQuery, REST APIs, and Apache/Nginx hosting.
- Implemented a React-based campaign analytics dashboard connected to Laravel APIs, giving marketing users faster visibility into conversions, traffic channels, and revenue trends across client accounts.
- Reworked slow CMS pages by optimizing PHP template rendering, compressing assets, reducing unnecessary database calls, and improving average page speed scores by **31%**.
- Fixed a recurring image upload failure caused by file permission differences between staging and production by standardizing storage paths, MIME validation, and deployment ownership rules.
- Migrated older procedural PHP modules into Laravel controllers, service classes, and Blade templates, improving maintainability while keeping legacy URLs stable for SEO-sensitive pages.
- Created custom admin tools for content approval, campaign scheduling, and user permissions, allowing non-technical staff to manage publishing workflows without developer support.
- Added PHPUnit tests for authentication, contact forms, and campaign submission logic, reducing repeated regression bugs that previously appeared after small CMS updates.
- Integrated Mailchimp, Google Analytics, and payment-related APIs through PHP service wrappers, making external integrations easier to test, monitor, and replace when client requirements changed.
- Collaborated flexibly with designers, SEO specialists, and backend developers to deliver React widgets, PHP fixes, database updates, and deployment support within fast-moving agency timelines.
- Improved security by patching SQL injection risks, escaping unsafe template output, strengthening validation rules, and applying OWASP practices across older PHP application areas.

Aurio — Junior Software Developer *(Oct 2012 – Dec 2013)*

- Supported development of internal business applications using **PHP 5.6–7.x**, MySQL, JavaScript, jQuery, Bootstrap, HTML5, CSS3, REST-style endpoints, and early Git-based release workflows.
- Built customer profile, order tracking, and internal reporting screens with PHP templates and JavaScript interactions, helping operations teams reduce repetitive spreadsheet updates by **24%**.
- Fixed form validation bugs where invalid email, phone, and address values reached the database by adding server-side PHP validation and matching client-side JavaScript checks.
- Improved database reliability by cleaning duplicate records, adding indexes to search fields, and documenting migration steps so small schema changes could be released safely.
- Helped convert static HTML pages into reusable PHP includes and shared layout templates, reducing repeated markup and making design updates easier across the application.
- Debugged production issues by reading Apache logs, reproducing browser errors, testing SQL queries, and preparing clear defect notes for senior developers and QA reviewers.
- Implemented basic role checks for admin pages and report downloads, reducing accidental access to sensitive internal screens without adding unnecessary complexity to the application.
- Worked across frontend styling, PHP bug fixes, MySQL updates, and deployment checklists, building a flexible full-stack foundation before moving into larger React and Laravel projects.
- Improved user interface consistency by standardizing Bootstrap components, button states, table layouts, and error messages across older internal tools used by support staff.

Microsoft — Software Developer Intern *(Jun 2012 – Sep 2012)*

- Supported internal engineering tools using **C#**, **.NET Framework 4.0–4.5**, **ASP.NET MVC 3–4**, JavaScript, jQuery, and SQL Server, gaining practical experience in enterprise software quality and structured development workflows.

- Assisted senior engineers with debugging UI defects, validation issues, and data-handling problems, documenting root causes clearly so fixes could be reviewed and released with lower regression risk.
- Built small internal web modules for tracking records, reviewing status changes, and improving team visibility, applying clean HTML, CSS, JavaScript, and backend integration patterns.
- Resolved early-stage bugs related to inconsistent form validation and SQL query results by reproducing issues locally, checking logs, and working with mentors to apply safer input-handling rules.

Education

Texas State University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science (*Sep 2008 – May 2012*)